

Set up n8n locally using Node.js (npm method)

Tuesday, 30 June 2026 7:18 am

For students, running n8n via Node.js (npm) is better if you want a fast, lightweight setup with zero learning curve,

while Docker is the better choice if you want to learn in-demand DevOps skills, use community AI templates, or easily manage database integrations. [\[1, 2\]](#)

The choice ultimately depends on whether your priority is quickly building automations or building a technical portfolio.

Feature 	Node.js (npm) Installation	Docker Installation
Best For	Fast testing and low-spec laptops.	Project portfolios and long-term hosting.
Setup Speed	Less than 2 minutes.	10 to 15 minutes (requires Docker Desktop).
RAM Usage	Low (~300 MB).	Heavy (~1.5 GB+ for Docker engine + n8n).
Storage Need	Minimal.	Gigabytes of disk space for container images.
Learning Curve	None if JavaScript/npm is familiar.	Moderate (requires learning basic CLI commands).

Step by Step Guide

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01 • Install Node.js

n8n requires Node.js version 18 or higher.

Download from **nodejs.org** → **LTS version**

- Install Node.js and npm together
- Verify installation with `node -v` and `npm -v`

02 • Create Project Folder

Organize n8n files in a dedicated directory.

- Make a folder, e.g., `mkdir n8n-local`
- Navigate into it: `cd n8n-local`

03 • Install n8n via npm

Use npm to install n8n globally.

Run in terminal

- `npm install n8n -g`
- This makes n8n available system-wide

04 • Start n8n Quick Launch

Run n8n to start the local server.

Run in terminal

- Type `n8n`
- It will start on **`http://localhost:5678`**

05 • Access Web UI

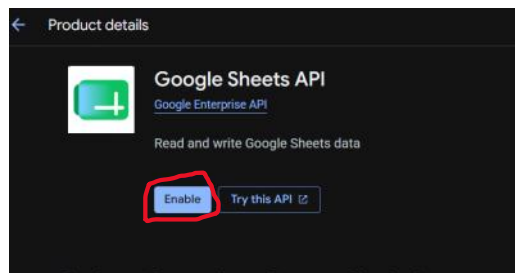
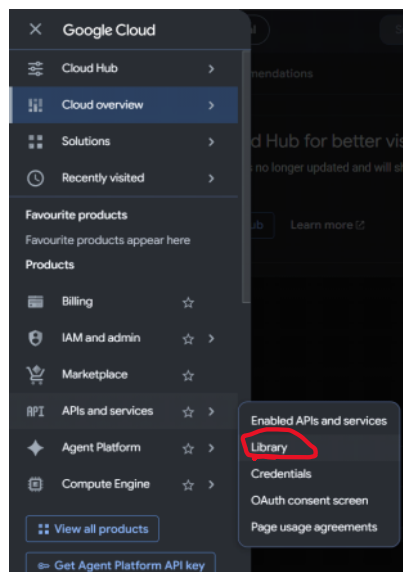
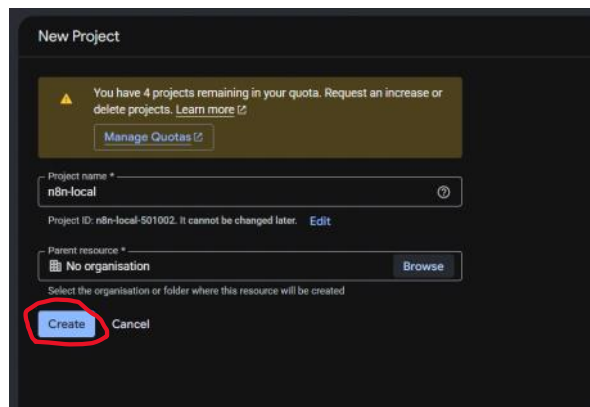
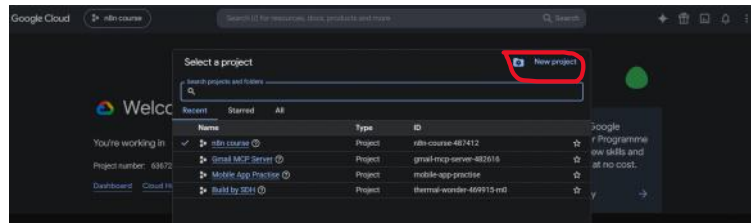
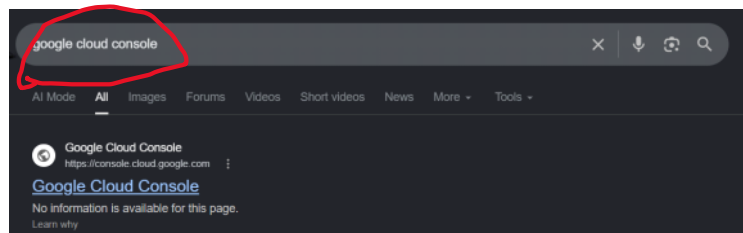
Open n8n editor in your browser.

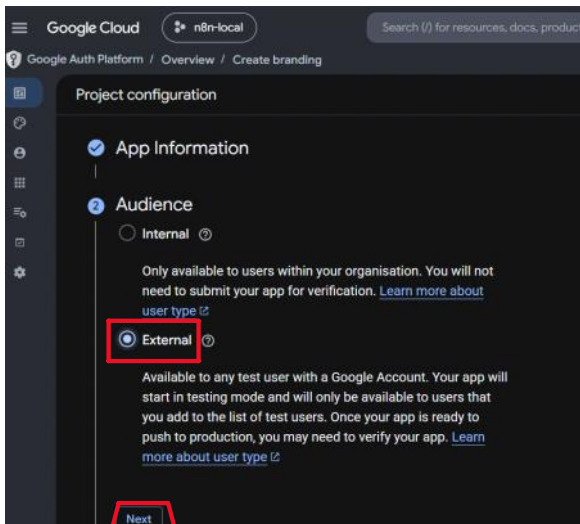
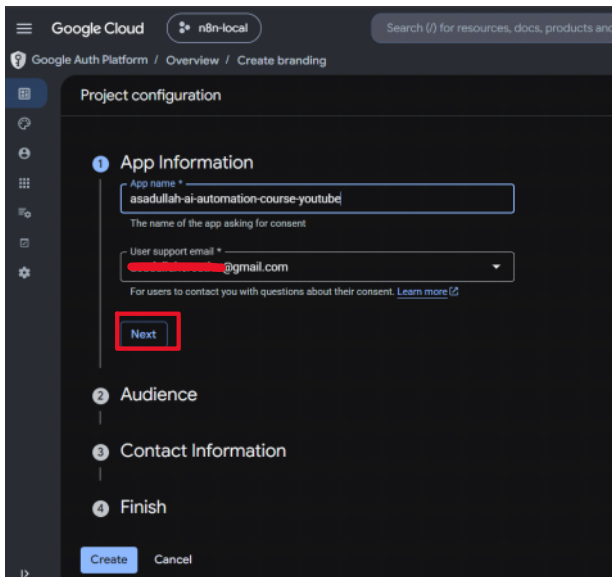
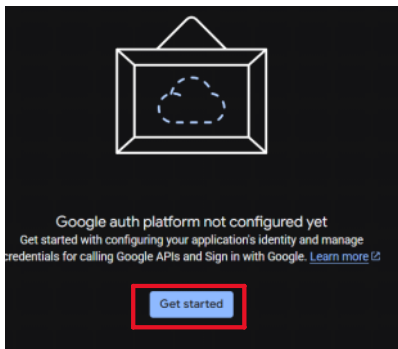
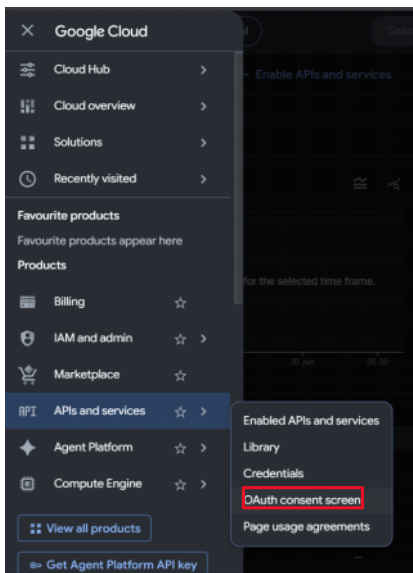
- Go to `http://localhost:5678`
- Create workflows directly in the UI

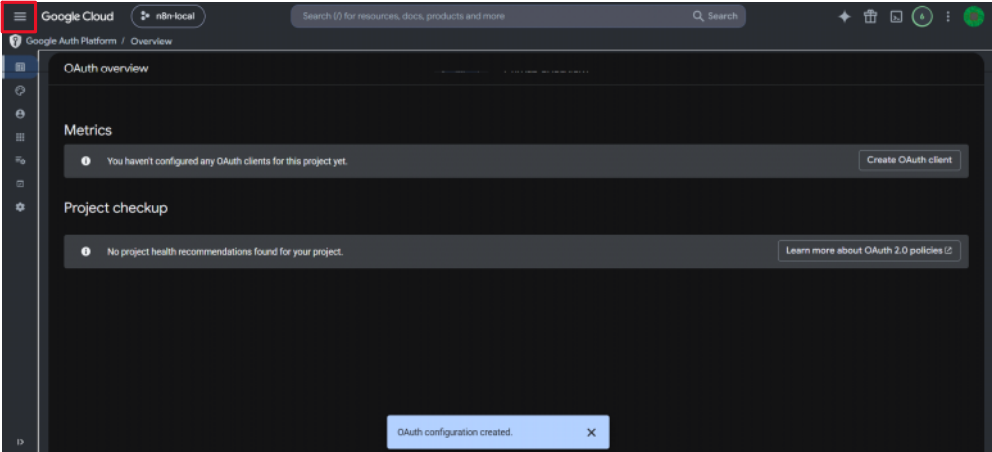
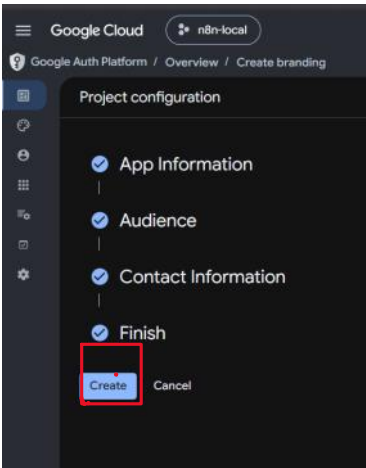
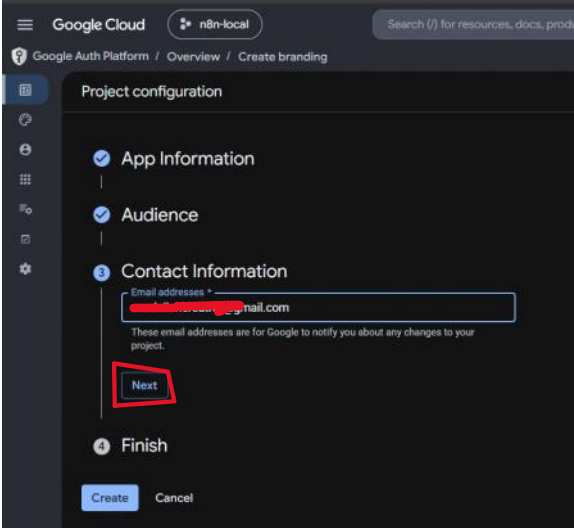
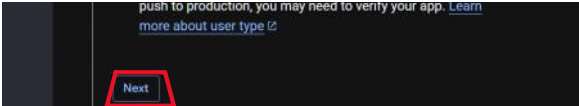
Google Credentials

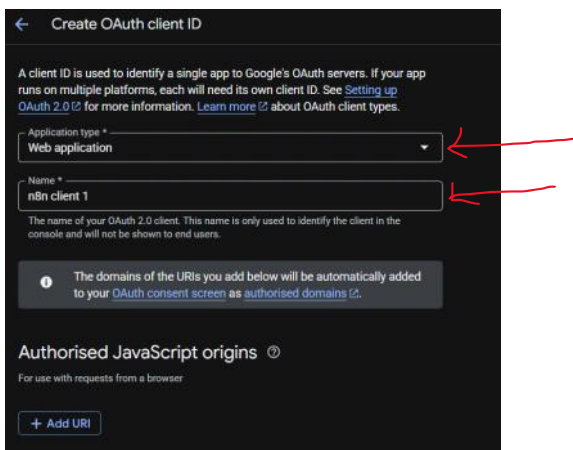
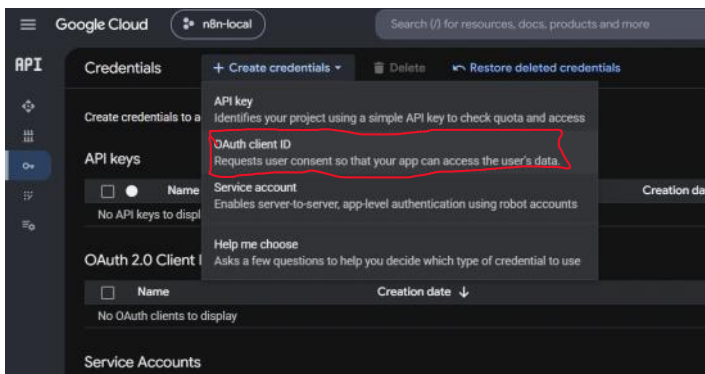
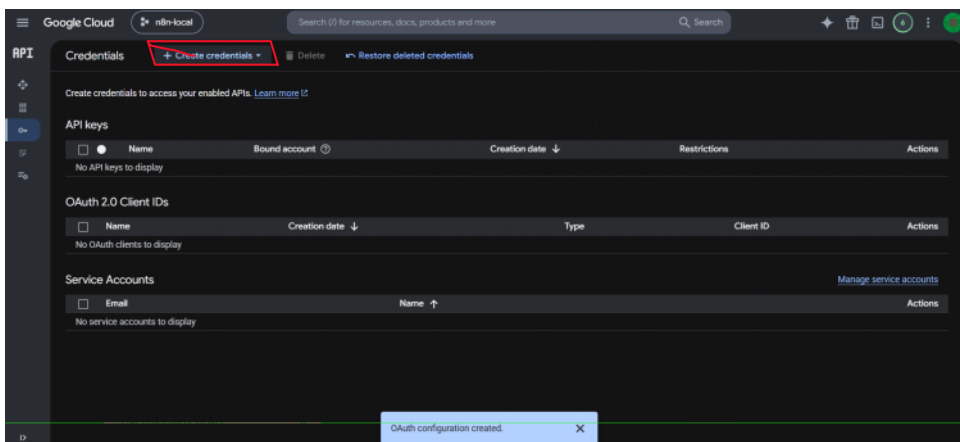
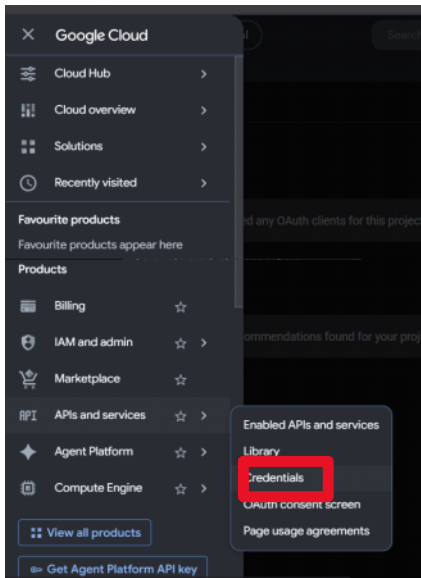
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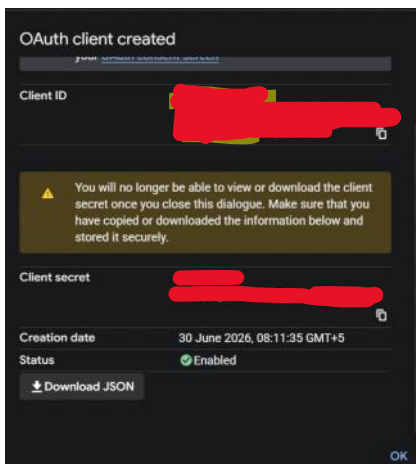
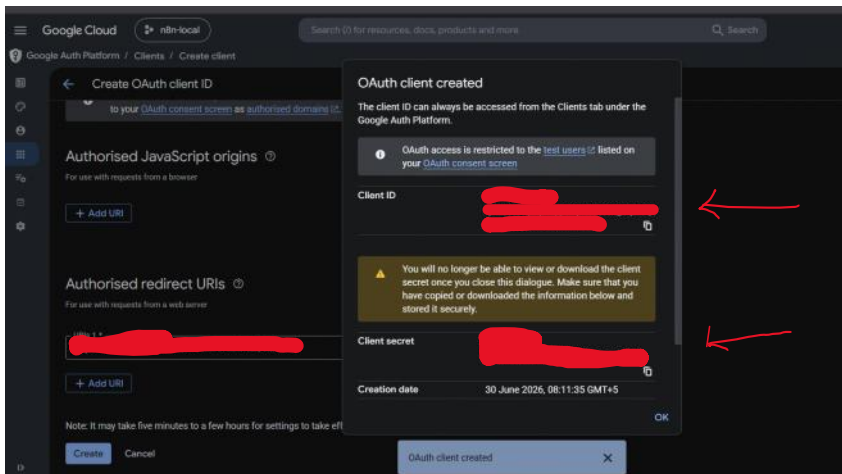
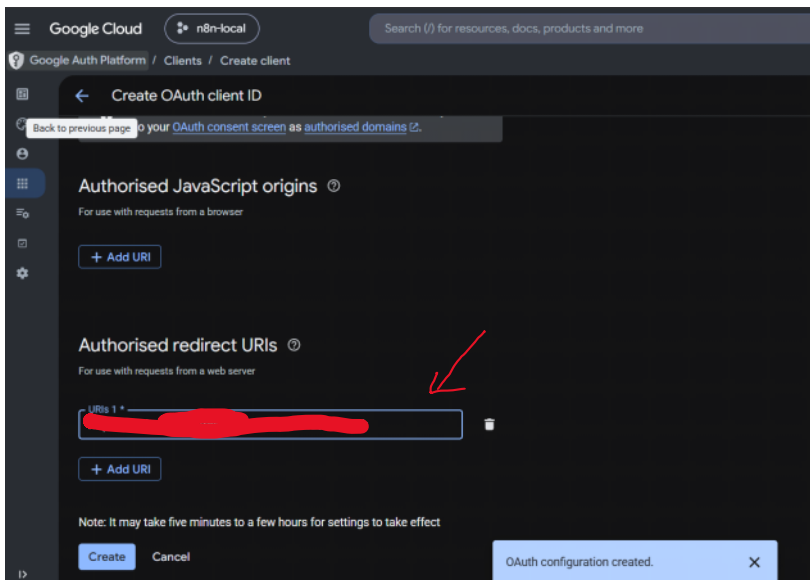
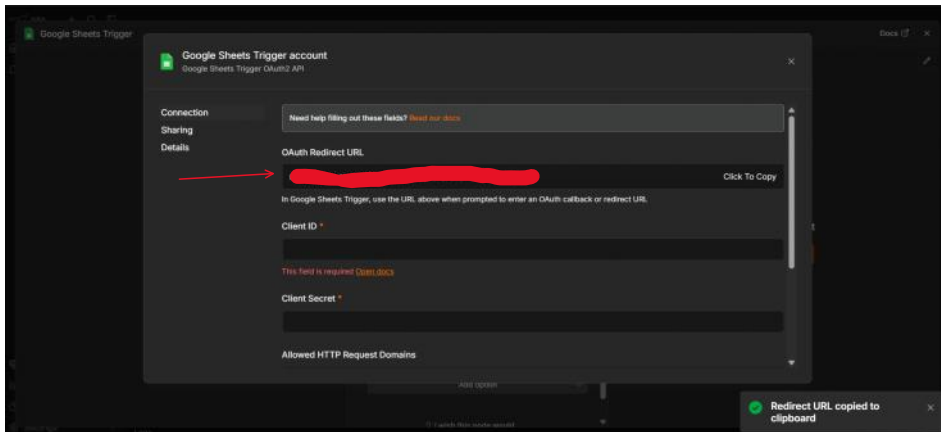
Oauth Url : <https://console.cloud.google.com/apis/credentials/oauthclient>





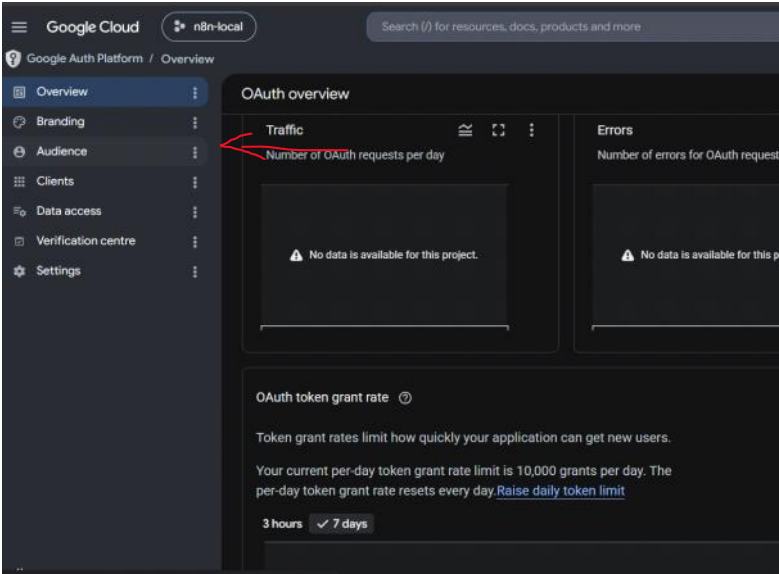
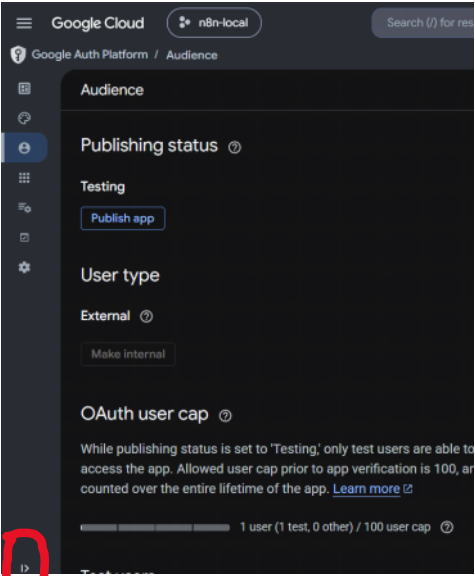
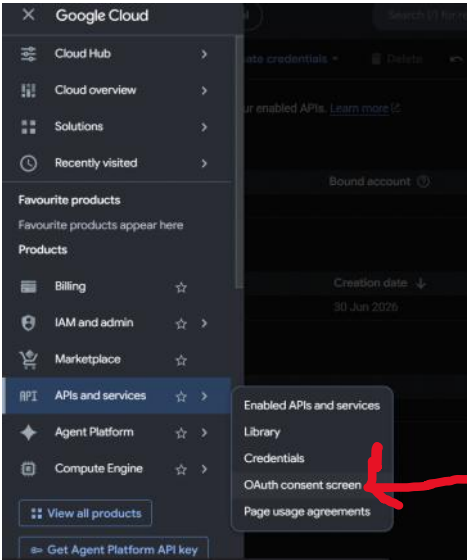
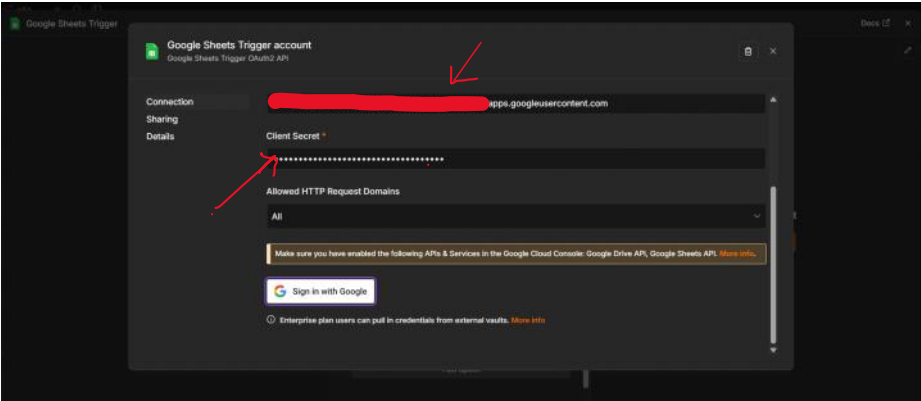


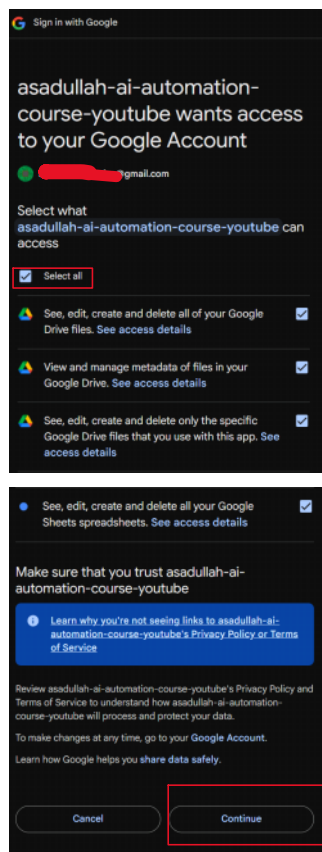
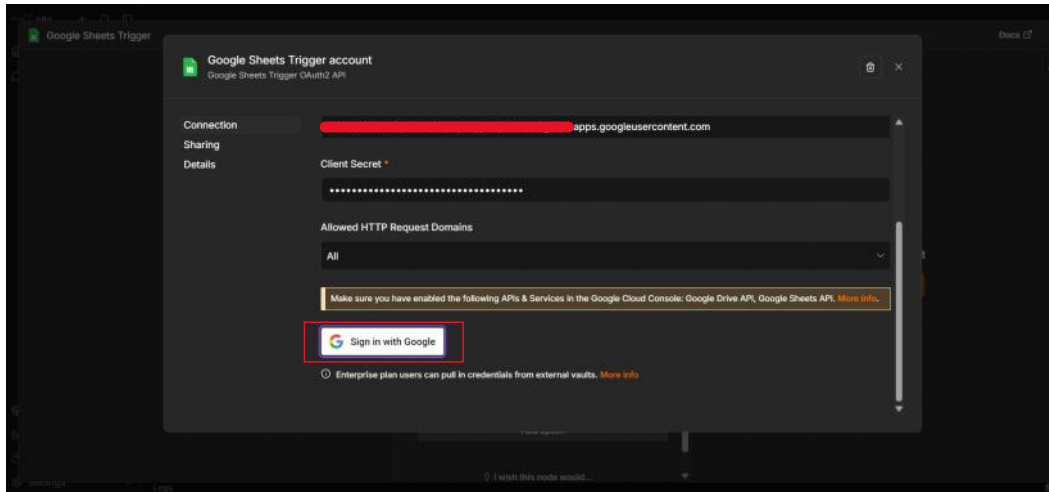
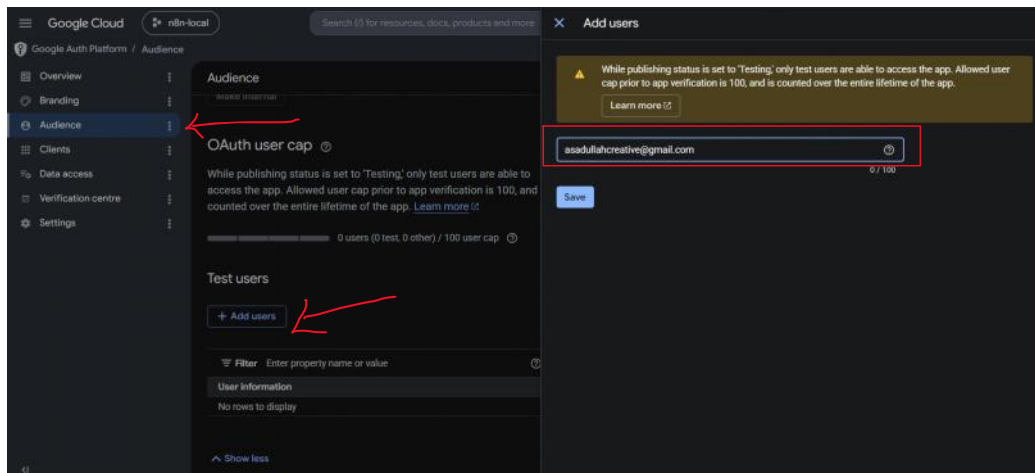




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